

# DANCER

## Natarajasana

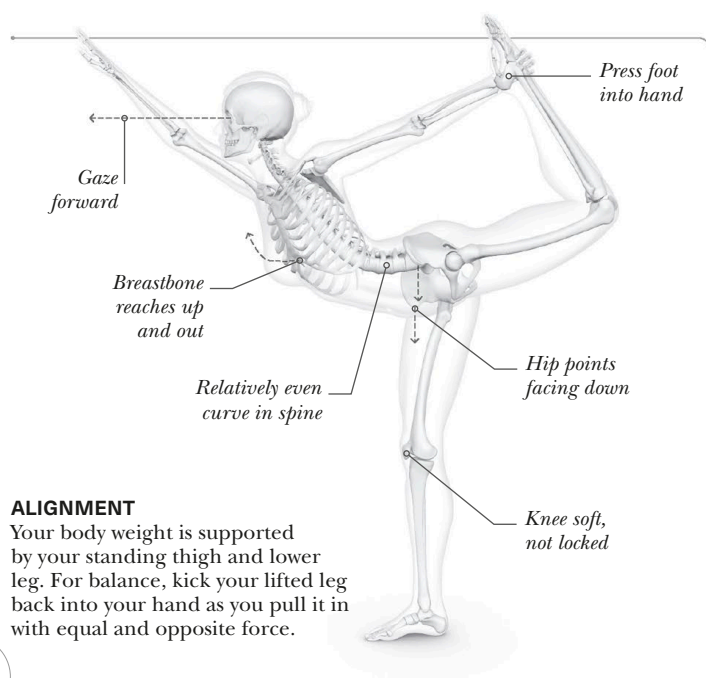
**Dancer pose is a challenging static balancing pose, which also develops strength, flexibility, and agility. Dynamic balance skills are required to transition in and out of the pose with grace, though you can always hold onto a wall or chair for steadiness.**

## THE BIG PICTURE

Large muscles of your standing hip, thigh, and leg dramatically engage to help you balance on one leg. The front of your lifted hip and thigh stretch, as you kick back as a counterbalance. Your back muscles engage to come into a backbend, while your chest and abdomen stretch. Your neck is extended out long, and your shoulders are relaxed.

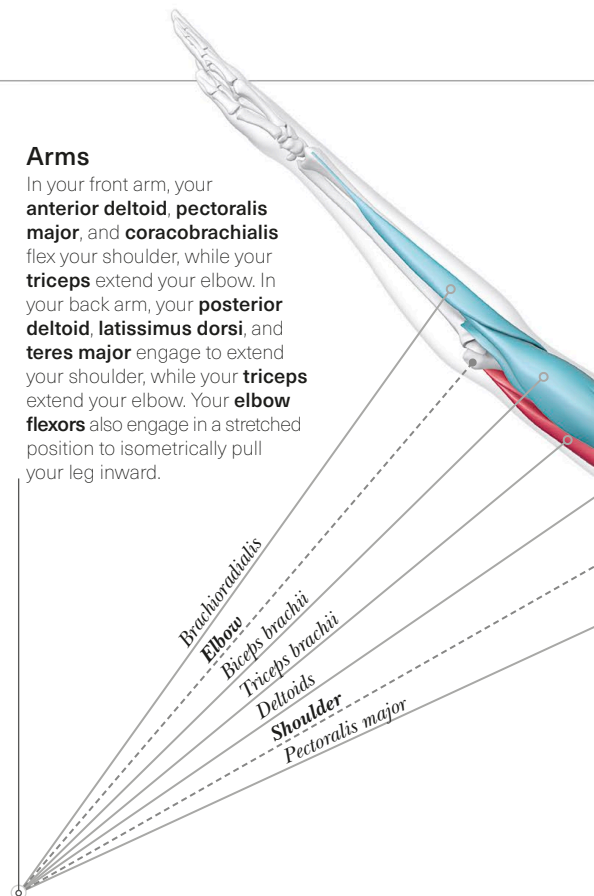
### KEY

- Joints
- Muscles
- Engaging
- Engaging while stretching
- Stretching

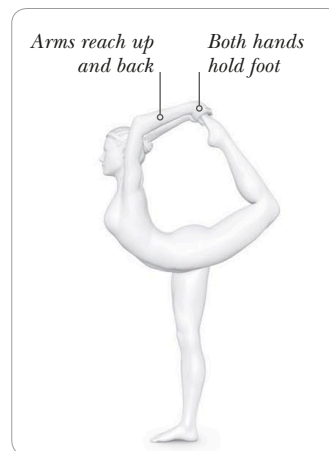


### Arms

In your front arm, your **anterior deltoid**, **pectoralis major**, and **coracobrachialis** flex your shoulder, while your **triceps** extend your elbow. In your back arm, your **posterior deltoid**, **latissimus dorsi**, and **teres major** engage to extend your shoulder, while your **triceps** extend your elbow. Your **elbow flexors** also engage in a stretched position to isometrically pull your leg inward.



Arms reach up and back  
Both hands hold foot



### VARIATION

For a challenge, reach both arms up and back to grasp your big toe. If you feel pinching in your lower back, don't go as deeply into the bend. Also try using a strap looped around your ankle.